Yet Another Aside



While YARD claims to be short for "Yay! A Ruby Documentation Tool," it likely was named in reference to the long standing open source tradition of starting acronyms with YA for "yet another." We think the first tool to to this was the Yacc parser-generator (for Yet Another Compiler Compiler), but there's also YAML (originally Yet Another Markup Language, now styled as YAML Ain't Markup Language, which is a whole other open-source tradition of recursive acronyms), and some quick internet searching reveals YaST, YAF, YAPM, YAPP, and who knows how many more.

Here's our same minimal counter example with some YARD tags:

rdoc/example_with_yardoc/counter.rb

```
# Implements a simple accumulator, whose
# value is accessed via the attribute
# _counter_. Calling the method Counter#inc
# increments this value.
# @author Dave Thomas
# @note This is only a minimal example
# @version 1.0
class Counter
  # The current value of the count
  attr_reader :counter

  # create a new Counter with the given
  # initial value
  # @param initial_value [Integer] the initial value of the counter
  def initialize(initial_value = 0)
    @counter = initial_value
  end

  # increment the current value of the count
  # @example Increment the counter
  #   Counter.new.increment #=> counter.value == 1
  # @return [Integer] The new value of the counter
  def inc
    @counter += 1
  end
end
```

The comments are basically the same, but we've augmented them with tags like @author, @param, and @return.

To use YARD, we need to gem install yard or have it in our Gemfile, then the command to just run the current directory is:

```
$ yard doc .
```

The resulting HTML documentation goes in a doc directory. (YARD also creates a .yardoc directory with it's own information). As you can see, the HTML is more detailed and uses the tags appropriately: